

19. News Article on Beta (Swiss Source) Threat of Hostage Crisis in Beta

At 4:30pm Friday, local tribespeople forcibly removed nine skilled surgeons supporting humanitarian efforts in Beta from their workplace at the local Health for All hospital and confined them to a single residence. At 9:30am Saturday, the head surgeon, escorted by armed guards, was permitted to speak from the compound of the residence. He confirmed that all nine of them are safe and have their basic needs, before being escorted back inside.

The surgeons, all of Swiss nationality, arrived in 2020 to assist during an intertribal conflict. Three years later, the tensions have eased and life has largely returned to normal. This looming hostage crisis represents the growing dangers for humanitarian aid workers supporting operations in developing nations such as Beta. The Swiss government is working closely with Health for All for the safe return of this courageous surgical team.